



SVPMUN
IV EDITION

ICE: HOMELAND SECURITY INVESTIGATIONS

GUÍA ACADÉMICA





LETTER OF THE CHAIR:

Dear Delegates,

As the chair of the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, it is a pleasure to greet you and welcome you to this committee on SVPMUN IV EDITION.

In this occasion the debate is not going to simply hold recommendations or amend documents, it'll be focused on actions to address a real and dangerous situation. Upholding the necessary standards of diplomacy, strategy, redaction and academy, hoping that all delegates are focused on the real objective of the conference.

Also, we want to hear everyone's views, thoughts and logical thinking. The best forums are always the ones that have teamwork, academic bases and meaningful speeches. We don't hope less from you, wishing you the best of luck regarding this journey.

Sincerely,

President

Francisco Chacón

Vicepresident

María José Bastidas

Academic Advisor

Prof. Jesús Sanchez



I. ABOUT HOMELAND SECURITY INVESTIGATIONS

1.- COMMITTEE OPERATIONS AND POWERS

Homeland Security Investigations (HSI) operates as the primary investigative arm of the United States Department of Homeland Security (DHS), holding a sweeping global mandate to identify, disrupt, and dismantle transnational criminal organizations (TCOs) that threaten national security, public safety, and economic integrity. Established following the Homeland Security Act of 2002, HSI possesses unique and robust legal authorities that extend well beyond traditional domestic law enforcement.

Through an extensive network of international attaché offices spanning dozens of countries, the committee exercises broad extraterritorial jurisdiction to investigate cross-border criminal enterprises, including illicit trade, international human smuggling and trafficking, intellectual property theft, cybercrime, and global narcotics networks.

The statutory powers vested allow its special agents to issue federal administrative and judicial subpoenas, conduct sophisticated undercover operations, execute search and seizure warrants, and freeze or forfeit illicit assets. Furthermore, the committee operates under a framework of specialized domestic and international partnerships. It collaborates closely with federal prosecutor offices, the Department of Justice, and intelligence agencies, while simultaneously bridging gaps with foreign governments through mutual legal assistance treaties (MLATs) and specialized bilateral units. By combining domestic enforcement capabilities with global reach, HSI targets the entire lifecycle of transnational criminal syndicates, striking at their leadership, operational infrastructure, and financial lifelines simultaneously.

1.- OPERATIONAL MECHANISMS

To effectively neutralize criminal networks, HSI leverages an expansive extraterritorial footprint anchored by international attaché offices embedded within U.S. embassies, consulates, and military commands globally. This international architecture allows agents to address cross-border criminality, such as human smuggling and trafficking syndicates, international narcotics distribution networks, and advanced intellectual property theft, at its foreign source. HSI operationalizes its international strategy through specialized frameworks like Transnational



Criminal Investigative Units (TCIUs), which integrate vetted foreign law enforcement personnel and judicial authorities to build high-impact joint cases, execute foreign-backed raids, and stem the flow of precursor chemicals and illicit capital.

In addition to financial disruption, HSI utilizes cross-border task forces, such as Border Enforcement Security Task Forces (BEST), that bring together local, state and international law enforcement to interdict contraband at critical ports of entry, transit hubs, and border corridors. The committee heavily leverages advanced technological tools, including bulk data analytics platforms like the Repository for Analytics in a Virtualized Environment (RAVE), biometric identification systems, telecommunication intercepts, and cyber-forensic capabilities, to track transnational movements in real time. A vital instrument in this arsenal is the Transnational Criminal Investigative Unit (TCIU) program, which embeds vetted foreign law enforcement officers with HSI agents to facilitate seamless, cross-border information sharing and joint operations.

To conclude, it's critical to understand how specific documentation drives enforcement and court actions. The following summaries clarify the distinct roles of three critical papers used by authorities during immigration and legal proceedings:

- **Administrative Immigration Warrant:** An “ICE warrant” is a form issued by certain immigration officers that names an individual ICE claims is subject to removal (aka deportation), and directs various federal immigration enforcement agents to arrest that individual. ICE warrants are issued for civil violations of immigration law, not criminal charges. They are also sometimes called “administrative warrants” or “immigration warrants.” An ICE warrant directs various federal immigration enforcement agents to arrest the person named in the warrant.
- **Notice to Appear “NTA”:** The Notice to Appear (NTA) is the official document that starts removal proceedings against a foreign national. It will require them to appear in immigration court for the initial Master Calendar hearing. The Notice to Appear includes one or more reasons DHS believes you should be removed from the United States, called charges. The Notice to Appear may also include the date and time of your first hearing.
- **Target-Specific Subpoena:** A subpoena is a legally binding order compelling individuals to appear before a court or legal proceeding, such as a



congressional hearing, to testify under oath or produce relevant documents. It's sometimes referred to as a writ or administrative summons.

II. TOPIC ANALYSIS

Transnational criminal organizations have increasingly weaponized vulnerable migrant populations, refugee movements, and border corridors to mask and facilitate the smuggling of fentanyl and associated contraband. This convergence creates a multidimensional operational environment where humanitarian crises are systematically exploited by cartels for financial and logistical gain. According to global analyses by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), the rapid expansion of synthetic drug markets is heavily driven by low operational costs, flexible supply chains, and the systematic exploitation of global vulnerabilities. This convergence creates a multidimensional operational environment where humanitarian crises are exploited by cartels for financial and logistical gain, requiring a comprehensive response that balances border security with human rights protections.

This modern security nexus creates a multi-layered operating environment where humanitarian emergencies are deliberately compounded by criminal exploitation. Cartels do not view migration routes and drug distribution channels as separate vectors, rather, they treat them as completely integrated logistical ecosystems. Consequently, addressing this topic requires dissecting an intricate web where human rights abuses, border governance failures, global financial corruption, and international chemical commerce converge into a single transnational crisis.

Historically, criminal syndicates operating across the Americas focused primarily on human smuggling, alien transportation, and the trafficking of plant-based narcotics such as cocaine, heroin, and marijuana. These traditional models relied heavily on direct agricultural cultivation and extensive supply chains. However, over the past decade, a profound structural shift occurred as cartels recognized the exponential profit margins, lower production overhead, and ease of concealment offered by high-potency synthetic opioids like fentanyl.

To facilitate this transition, TCOs adapted their historical smuggling infrastructure. They repurposed established migration pathways, clandestine border-crossing routes, and human-smuggling safe houses to transport chemical precursors from international manufacturers, primarily sourced from East Asia, to clandestine laboratories in North America.



Past actions by international and domestic authorities largely treated drug trafficking and migrant smuggling as separate enforcement silos, a historical oversight that allowed cartels to exploit regulatory gaps between immigration enforcement and counter-narcotics strategies.

1.- THE TOPIC AND THE HSI

The US non-immigrant visa system processes millions of applications each year via Form DS-160 on the Consular Electronic Application Centre (CEAC) platform. Whilst this system was designed to facilitate legitimate flows of trade, labour and tourism, transnational criminal organisations have managed to circumvent the administrative and consular verification checks.

HSI is committed to identifying and disrupting the movement of illicit proceeds generated by these criminal organizations and activities in an effort to safeguard our nation's trade, travel and financial systems. For this reason, our workforce maintains effective relationships throughout the global law enforcement community and works closely with our domestic and international partners at every level to ensure the safety of all Americans.

Also, it's the largest contributor to the FBI-led Joint Terrorism Task Forces and employs its unique and exclusive immigration and trade-based authorities to disrupt terrorist networks and prevent attacks against the homeland. This work includes HSI initiating investigations into transnational criminal organizations and subjects of national security concern or interest who are involved in narcotics smuggling, human trafficking and smuggling, and immigration document and benefit fraud, as well as investigating trade-based money laundering and intellectual property crimes used to finance or support terrorists or their activities. HSI is also responsible for preventing terrorist groups, illicit procurement networks, and hostile nations from acquiring U.S. military hardware, sensitive technical data, dual-use technology, and other materials used to develop weapons of mass destruction.

Indeed, HSI prevents the illegal movement of people into the United States through aggressive investigative strategies alongside DHS and other federal, state and local law enforcement partners. Human smuggling is often a gateway crime for additional criminal offenses, including illegal immigration, identity theft, document and benefit fraud, gang activity, financial fraud, terrorism, and other national security threats. Transnational criminal organizations (TCOs) that operate criminal travel networks provide the means for special interest aliens (SIA), terrorists, and



other violators who may seek to harm or exploit the United States to illegally enter the country.

Since its inception, it has actively engaged in a comprehensive strategy to combat the smuggling of SIAs into or toward the United States. The inherent dangers associated with human smuggling activity pose a threat to public safety and create grave humanitarian concerns. HSI has encountered smuggled undocumented aliens who have been kidnapped, taken hostage, beaten, sexually assaulted, threatened with murder, or have lost their life as a result of the dangerous conditions created by human smuggling. Additionally, smugglers have been exploiting loopholes in our immigration system by presenting fraudulent documents alleging familial relationships that do not exist.

2.- HISTORICAL CONTEXT AND PAST ACTIONS

Alterations to visa applications were taken as minor documentary offences prior to the reorganisation of national security following the attacks of 11 September 2001. With the creation of the Department of Homeland Security, the monitoring of visa fraud was established as a priority national security issue.

Additionally, the development of the continuous visa verification system made possible a constant cross-check data from the Consular Data Centre (CCD) against the Terrorist Screening Database (TSDB) and law enforcement records. With the rapid spread of the fentanyl and synthetic opioid epidemic, the OCTs diversified their operational tactics in order to mitigate these problems. Since then, DHS personnel are on the front lines to detect and prevent fentanyl and its precursor chemicals from flowing into our country.

Likewise, more than 90% of interdicted fentanyl is stopped at Ports of Entry (POEs), where cartels attempt to smuggle it primarily in vehicles driven by U.S. citizens. CBP and HSI throughout the past two years have run operations that mobilized hundreds of personnel – CBP officers, special agents, import specialists, and intelligence analysts – through surges and deployments at Southwest Border POEs, airports, express consignment facilities, international mail facilities, container stations, and warehouses across the country.



- Launched in October 2023, in Southern California, Operation Apollo is a CBP counter-fentanyl operation that disrupts drug and chemical supplies, collects and shares intelligence, and leverages valuable state and local law enforcement partnerships. Operation Apollo expanded into Arizona in April 2024. In July, CBP announced Operation Apollo X to expand that kind of collaboration to El Paso, Texas.
- Other recent operations include:
 - Operation Blue Lotus, launched in March 2023, surged CBP and HSI resources to Southwest Border POEs and worked with state, local, Tribal, and territorial partners to expose networks. Operation Four Horsemen was a complementary United States Border Patrol (USBP) operation to stop fentanyl between POEs and at checkpoints near the border. As a result of these two operations, DHS seized nearly 10,000 pounds of fentanyl, and more than 10,000 pounds of other narcotics like cocaine and methamphetamines.
 - Operation Artemis, a collaboration between CBP and HSI, targeted the illicit fentanyl supply chain, leveraging multidisciplined interagency "jump teams" at strategic locations. The four month Operation Artemis led to over 900 seizures, including over 13,000 pounds of fentanyl precursor chemicals.
 - Operation Rolling Wave surged inbound inspections at Southwest Border checkpoints, covering every sector and employing predictive analysis and intelligence sharing.

Furthermore, as part of the efforts to combat human trafficking, HSI S.T.O.P. was established as a trafficking initiative that aims to reduce human trafficking through strategic engagement with industries that are associated with, or could be at high risk of, human trafficking. The initiative, which was the first in HSI's agency-wide Strategic Targeted Outreach Programme (S.T.O.P.) outreach campaign, provides industry-specific typologies and red flag indicators to legitimate business sectors to enhance their ability to recognise and report potential instances of human trafficking. By implementing this focused outreach strategy, HSI hopes to minimize the number of human trafficking victims or cases that go unreported and to increase the number of leads referred to HSI and its partners for investigation. This will, in turn, lead to the identification and rescue of more victims of human trafficking and to the disruption and dismantling of trafficking networks.



Through the falsification of data on the Electronic Non-Immigrant Visa Application (Form DS-160), the manipulation of the Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) and the exploitation of temporary worker programmes (H-2A and H-2B), TCOs have established formal channels of entry. These channels facilitate debt bondage amongst vulnerable workers and provide logistical cover for the transport of synthetic drugs and the procurement of chemical precursors.

Visa Category	Portal System Exploited or	Abuse Mechanism
H-2A / H-2B (Temporary Work)	Labour Certification and CEAC Portal (DS-160)	Creation of front contractors; unlawful collection of recruitment fees.
F-1 / OPT (Students / Training)	SEVIS System / Employer Database	Registration of phantom employers and educational institutions.
B1 / B2 (Tourism and Business)	Form DS-160 and Consular Interview	False declarations of socio-economic ties and use of stolen identities.



III. CURRENT SITUATION AND RESEARCH GUIDE

Today, criminal syndicates perpetrate severe dual-threat operations by forcing migrants to act as unwitting drug couriers or "mules" under threats of violence, or by leveraging human trafficking debts to finance cartel operations. Concurrently, the global supply chain for synthetic opioids remains highly resilient, with precursor chemicals flowing from international manufacturers to clandestine laboratories in North America through heavily fragmented shell companies and decentralized shipping channels.

The committee's operations are grounded in robust domestic and international legal frameworks. The Immigration and Nationality Act (INA) provides essential legal mechanisms for targeting alien smuggling and transnational gang activities. Internationally, instruments such as the International Narcotics Control Strategy Report (INCSR) guide evaluations of global cooperation, complemented by relevant Security Council resolutions aimed at dismantling the financial networks of transnational organized crime and curbing chemical precursor diversion.

HSI occupies a pivotal strategic position in this crisis, uniquely situated to address both migration enforcement and synthetic drug trafficking. Because modern cartels rarely operate in functional silos, they frequently integrate their human smuggling pipelines with their drug distribution networks, utilizing the same routes, safe houses, and corrupt facilitators for both illicit activities. Consequently, HSI is structurally optimized to dismantle this dual threat. By leveraging its combined jurisdiction over immigration violations, border security, and transnational narcotics trafficking, the committee can target the overlapping logistics and infrastructure that enable TCOs to profit from both human misery and synthetic drug distribution.

1.- LEGAL FRAMEWORK AND PREVIOUS RESOLUTIONS

The legal framework under which HSI takes action against visa fraud and fentanyl trafficking encompasses federal procedural legislation and instruments:

- **The Immigration and Nationality Act (INA):**
 - **Section 212(a)(2)(C):** It permanently blocks any person in respect of whom there is a reason to believe that they are involved or have been involved in the trafficking of substances—such as fentanyl or its



chemical precursors. In fact, no prior criminal conviction is required; intelligence reports from HSI or the DEA are sufficient. This restriction extends to associates, financiers and family members who have knowingly benefited from drug trafficking proceeds in the last five years.

- **Sections 212(a)(2)(H) and (I):** A permanent visa ineligibility is imposed on those who commit, conspire to commit or collude in human trafficking offences. It also serves for cracking down on networks that exploit non-immigrant visa schemes (such as the H-2A or H-2B temporary work programmes) where workers suffer from debt bondage, passport confiscation and forced labour.
- **Section 212(a)(6)(E):** It criminalises human smuggling. Such law doesn't require money to be exchanged or the existence of a financial gain; it applies to anyone who assists or facilitates the unauthorised entry of another person into the US. Furthermore, when tackling the digital and consular spheres, it covers recruiters, fraudulent travel agencies and advisers who alter documents or help to include ineligible individuals in group visa applications.
- **Section 212(a)(6)(C)(i):** It imposes a lifetime ban on anyone who attempts to obtain, or does obtain, a visa or immigration benefit through deception or the deliberate alteration of serious information. Therefore, such a section provides the legal basis for penalising organisations that falsify data on the DS-160 or DS-260 digital forms, set up shell companies to apply for work visas, or use stolen identities to facilitate cartel operations and the movement of fentanyl couriers.
- **RICO Act (18 U.S.C. § 1961 et seq.):** It enables the prosecution of the leadership of criminal organisations through the demonstration of running a structure dedicated to extortion and organised crime, without it being necessary for the leaders to directly commit each offence. This requires proof of at least two related serious offences within a 10-year period.
- **Continuing Criminal Enterprise (CCE – 21 U.S.C. § 848):** Known as the 'Kingpin Statute', it is specifically designed to target the ringleaders of drug trafficking. It applies when an individual leads or manages five or more people in an ongoing, large-scale drug trafficking network and derives substantial income from it. Also, it enables the seeking of life sentences



without parole for cartel leaders who coordinate the production, importation and distribution of fentanyl on a transnational scale.

On the other hand, some of the most important resolutions include:

- **United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime (2000):** Also known as the Palermo Convention, it is the world's leading treaty against organised crime. It addresses arms trafficking, money laundering, corruption, judicial cooperation and extradition.
- **United Nations Security Council Resolution 2195 (2014):** It specifies on crimes that seem outside the terrorism linkage discussion. For instance, the resolution highlights drug traffickers' use of modern commerce to traffic in precursors and their use of online markets to sell synthetic drugs, in particular synthetic opioids. It encourages increased domestic prosecution of human trafficking, and details states' responsibilities to prevent the illicit manufacture of and trade in various categories of weapon.

2.- STUDY CASES

Operation Los Villatoros Harvesting (LVH):

In a joint investigation conducted by HSI and the Department of Justice's Civil Rights Division, the operators of the company Los Villatoros Harvesting were convicted of conspiracy under the RICO Act. The organisation used the H-2A visa programme to subject Mexican agricultural workers to forced labour schemes.

According to court documents, Alexander Villatoro Moreno, 53, also known as "Quichi," of Chiapas, Mexico, along with his co-defendants, operated and managed Los Villatoros Harvesting (LVH), a farm labor contracting company. Between approximately 2015 and 2017, LVH functioned as a criminal enterprise compelling victims to work in Florida, Kentucky, Indiana, Georgia and North Carolina. Villatoro Moreno and his co-defendants fraudulently recruited Mexican nationals to come into the United States on short-term, H-2A agricultural visas and misled the United States to secure valid H-2A visas for the victims.

Villatoro Moreno and his co-defendants charged workers exorbitant recruitment fees to work for LVH and lied to the victims about how much they would be paid, the hours they would work, the working conditions, and the reimbursement they would receive for paying recruitment fees and other expenses. Once in the United States, Villatoro Moreno and his co-defendants then compelled the workers to



provide long hours of physically demanding agricultural labor, six to seven days a week, for far less pay than they were entitled to under the law. In addition to the work conditions, Villatoro Moreno and his co-defendants used various coercive means to compel the victims' labor, including imposing debts on workers; confiscating the workers' passports; subjecting workers to crowded, unsanitary and degrading living conditions; verbally abusing and humiliating the workers; threatening workers with arrest, jail time, and deportation; isolating workers by preventing them from interacting with anyone other than LVH employees; and threatening to physically harm the workers' family members back in Mexico if the workers failed to comply with their demands.

When officials began investigating, Villatoro Moreno obstructed the federal investigation by helping to prepare false payroll information to conceal underpayments to the workers and distributing fake reimbursement receipts to the victims to make it appear that LVH was complying with the law by reimbursing the workers for their travel-related expenses. This case reflects the Department's commitment to protect the integrity of our nation's immigration system and hold those accountable who, after engaging in visa fraud, then use deception and coercion to abuse and exploit foreign workers.

Fentanyl trafficking network dismantled in Nevada; Crypto intervenes:

According to allegations in the criminal complaint, from at least 2024 to August 2, 2026, Adrian Ortiz Moreno, also known as "El Apache," a Mexican national, and Brenda Maria Moreno De Castro, a Mexican national and lawful permanent resident of the United States, and their co-defendants Martin Castro, Jr., David Romero Hernandez, Edgar Rosas, Juan Martinez Ramirez, a Mexican national, and Walter Estrada Carlos, a Mexican national, engaged in a continuing criminal enterprise to distribute fentanyl, a Schedule II controlled substance.

As a result of a Homeland Security Task Force investigation, Ortiz Moreno is charged with one count of continuing criminal enterprise. All seven defendants are charged with one count of conspiracy to distribute a controlled substance. Ortiz Moreno, Moreno De Castro, Estrada Carlos, Castro, Jr., and Hernandez are charged with one or more counts of possession with intent to distribute a controlled substance. Ortiz Moreno, Moreno De Castro, and Castro, Jr. are also charged with possession of a firearm in furtherance of a drug trafficking crime. As a result of a Homeland Security Task Force investigation, Ortiz Moreno and Moreno De Castro are each charged



with one count of continuing criminal enterprise and one count of possession of a firearm in furtherance of a drug trafficking crime. Castro, Jr., Hernandez, Rosas, Martinez Ramirez, and Estrada Carlos are each charged with one count of conspiracy to distribute a controlled substance. Ortiz Moreno, Moreno De Castro, and Estrada Carlos are each charged with one count of possession with intent to distribute a controlled substance; and Castro, Jr. is charged with one count of possession of a firearm in furtherance of a drug trafficking crime. If convicted, the maximum statutory penalty is life imprisonment. Silva.

The case—investigated by HSI, DEA, ATF, LVMPD, USMS, and FBI—is being prosecuted by the District of Nevada. This case is part of the Homeland Security Task Force (HSTF) initiative established by Executive Order 14159, Protecting the American People Against Invasion. The HSTF is a whole-of-government partnership dedicated to eliminating criminal cartels, foreign gangs, transnational criminal organizations, and human smuggling and trafficking rings operating in the United States and abroad.

Through historic interagency collaboration, the HSTF directs the full might of U.S. law enforcement towards identifying, investigating, and prosecuting the full spectrum of crimes committed by these organizations, which have long fueled violence and instability within our borders. In performing this work, the HSTF places special emphasis on investigating and prosecuting those engaged in child trafficking or other crimes involving children. The HSTF further utilizes all available tools to prosecute and remove the most violent criminal aliens from the United States. The Las Vegas HSTF comprises agents and officers with the FBI, HSI, DEA, ATF, IRS-CI, the Las Vegas Metropolitan Police Department, the United States Marshals Service, and Nevada Gaming Control Board with the prosecution being led by the U.S. Attorney's Office for the District of Nevada.



RECOMMENDATIONS FROM THE CHAIR:

1. You must research the committee's faculties,
2. Understand the cartel's sociopolitical adaptations during the years,
3. Be ready for sudden changes during committee sessions,
4. Your characters are fictional; therefore, please do not conduct any investigations based on their names,
5. Be aware of your statements, and use the correct words for understanding,
6. Use trustworthy academic sources for all your research,
7. Be confident about your knowledge, research and speech skills,
8. Be aware of all kinds of details while redacting,
9. Use an adapted vocabulary during all the sessions,
10. Distinguish and categorize the power outlined in the documents submitted,
11. Formalize your solutions through the correct use of the definitions provided,
12. Avoid neologism and modern idioms,
13. Look for operational records, interviews with those involved and well-known cases in your region,
14. Identify the specific problems affecting your area,
15. Do not prompt a one-sided investigation, but gain a better understanding of the topic.



KEY QUESTIONS:

- 1. How can consular and national security authorities optimise the preventive detection of fraud on Form DS-160 without slowing down the legitimate processing of work and student visas?**
2. What regulatory barriers prevent better cooperation between HSI, CBP and foreign law enforcement agencies within the framework of Transnational Criminal Investigation Units (TCIUs)?
3. What mechanisms ensure that migrants who have fallen victim to forced labour schemes can cooperate with HSI without fear of immigration reprisals?
4. How can we ensure that victims of labour trafficking in fraudulent visa schemes receive immediate protection (T/U visas) before being subject to removal proceedings?
5. How can federal authorities use the RICO Act to sanction labour contractors who exploit the H-2A and H-2B programmes?
6. How does the use of cryptocurrencies influence the financing of fentanyl precursors, and what tools could be used to neutralise these transactions?
7. What measures can be implemented to monitor SEVIS-registered companies that offer OPT training to F-1 visa students?
- 8. How can Transnational Criminal Investigation Units (TCIUs) be strengthened to disrupt fentanyl and human trafficking networks in their countries of origin?**



I. APPENDICES AND REFERENCES

GLOSSARY:

- **Department of Homeland Security (DHS):** The parent cabinet department of the United States government charged with protecting U.S. territory from terrorist attacks and man-made or natural threats, housing HSI.
- **Homeland Security Investigations (HSI):** The principal investigative arm of the U.S. Department of Homeland Security, responsible for investigating transnational criminal organizations and cross-border threats.
- **Border Enforcement Security Task Force (BEST):** Specialized, multi-agency task forces led by HSI that combine federal, state, local, tribal, and international law enforcement resources to combat cross-border criminal activity.
- **Immigration and Nationality Act (INA):** The foundational U.S. federal statute governing immigration law, providing statutory mechanisms for targeting alien smuggling and transnational gangs.
- **Bank Secrecy Act (BSA):** A U.S. federal law requiring financial institutions to assist U.S. government agencies in detecting and preventing money laundering and illicit capital flows.
- **Transnational Criminal Organization (TCO):** Self-perpetuating associations of individuals who operate transnationally to obtain power, influence, monetary, and/or commercial gains through illegal activities, utilizing sophisticated multi-jurisdictional networks.
- **TCIU (Transnational Criminal Investigative Unit):** Specialized units composed of foreign law enforcement officers vetted, trained, and partnered with HSI to investigate and prosecute transnational crimes at their source.
- **Illicit Financial Flows:** The movement of money illegally earned, transferred, or utilized across international borders, designed to obscure criminal origins and fund secondary crimes such as weapons trafficking and corruption.
- **4-anilino-N-phenethylpiperidine (ANPP):** A primary immediate chemical precursor utilized in the clandestine synthesis of fentanyl.
- **CEAC (Consular Electronic Application Centre):** The US Department of State's portal for completing and submitting visa applications electronically.
- **Continuing Criminal Enterprise (CCE):** A federal criminal offence (21 U.S.C. § 848) designed to punish the leaders of systematic drug trafficking networks.
- **Form DS-160:** Mandatory online application form for applying for a non-immigrant visa at US embassies and consulates.
- **H-2A / H-2B:** Non-immigrant visas for temporary agricultural (H-2A) and non-agricultural (H-2B) workers.



- **OPT (Optional Practical Training):** A benefit under the F-1 visa that allows graduate students to work temporarily in their field of specialisation.
- **RICO (Racketeer Influenced and Corrupt Organisations Act):** A federal law designed to combat organised crime by penalising participation in racketeering enterprises.
- **SEVIS (Student and Exchange Visitor Information System):** A national database that tracks and monitors students and exchange visitors in the United States.
- **T visa (Form I-914):** Non-immigrant status granted to victims of severe trafficking who cooperate with criminal investigations.
- **U visa (Form I-918):** Non-immigrant status reserved for victims of certain serious crimes who have suffered abuse and assist the authorities.

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